



PROGRESS REPORT

Namibia: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-29 · 140 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-29.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	A National Digital Strategy was published in August 2025 and a ministry strategic plan and ICT policy launched in January 2026, with neither text held. The digital strategy is in force and the national data centre it calls for was still at concept-note stage a month after publication; the document itself is not held and two sources give its period differently (strategy , readiness). The ministry's strategic plan and national ICT policy were launched at Opuwo in January 2026, prioritising affordable broadband and mobile coverage in rural and underserved areas, cybersecurity, data protection and electronic government, and naming high data costs, limited infrastructure and unequal access as the barriers; neither document text is held (plan).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	A national artificial-intelligence strategy is in development through the research council working group, guided by a completed readiness assessment. Consultations began under the council's working group and its technical advisory committees; no draft is published, and the ministry states the strategy is sequenced ahead of legislation (strategy , framework , coordination). The working group is a multi-stakeholder platform with science, data and skills committees and runs the national strategy process (group). A readiness assessment was completed by the council with the education ministry and an international body, and its findings were restated by the authors in February 2026; the report itself is not held (assessment).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The Data Protection Bill has not been tabled about thirteen years after drafting began, and the March 2022 draft remains the last version published for comment. A tabling was announced for September 2025 (announcement , return) and the bill was still in finalisation in August 2026, with no data-protection statute in force (finalisation , concerns). The March 2022 revised draft runs to fifty-nine pages and eight Parts, with the supervisory authority at Part 2 (draft). The 2020 version carries a Part on rights of the data subject, together with Parts on recourse to the judicial authority and on offences and penalties, none of which appears in the 2022 version, where access and correction survive only as controller obligations (2020 version , removal).	STALLED
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	A Cybercrime Bill was named as being finalised in July 2026, with no draft published and no tabling date given. Enforcement has relied on the electronic transactions statute, the communications statute and the penal code; cabinet approved cybercrime proposals in November 2025 (proposals) and the minister named the bill as being finalised alongside the data protection bill in July 2026 (finalisation). The base first names this bill in July 2026, and the national incident response team states in its own report that it cannot fully execute its mandate absent a cybersecurity law.	ADVANCED marginal

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The Civil Registration and Identification Act 13 of 2024 is the statutory basis for a single civil register and a unique identity number, and a gazette notice withdrawing older documents has not issued. The Act was assented in December 2024 as the basis for a single civil register, a unique identity number and identity-data confidentiality, and was read by officials in July 2026 as permitting institutions to accept either the physical card or its digital version, with disclosure conditional on the holder's consent; the commencement date is not established in this base (Act , reading). The notice that will end the validity of pre-independence cards, older documents and current machine-readable cards has not issued, so until it does the September 2026 card is additive rather than replacing anything (notice).	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	Artificial-intelligence legislation is announced as following the strategy, and the research council's own authors recorded no governance framework in place. The minister sequenced legislation behind the strategy, and nothing has been drafted or tabled (sequencing , framework). The research council's own authors recorded no artificial-intelligence governance framework in place as at February 2026. A strategy that is itself unpublished cannot yet ground a statute, so both halves of the governance question are pending on the same document.	NO CHANGE announced as following the strategy with nothing drafted or tabled
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	The Electronic Transactions Act 2019 has been in force since March 2021 and covers signatures, consumer protection and contracts but not personal data or cross-border flow. The Act is the interim instrument law enforcement relies on for cybercrime, with the communications statute and the penal code (Act). A regulatory profile records that it does not reach cross-border data flow, data localisation or personal data protection (profile). Company process under the corporate laws reform is routed through it, so it is doing more work than it was written for.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	The Access to Information Act 8 of 2022 is gazetted and not commenced, and no Information Commissioner has been appointed. Section 86 leaves commencement to a date determined by the minister, no commencement notice is held, and the Act runs to ten Parts and eighty-six sections whose compliance deadlines run from commencement (Act). Appointment machinery for the Commissioner and Deputy was itself gazetted in December 2024, setting five-year selection committee terms and a five-member quorum, made ahead of the Act's own commencement, so the annual report the Act requires cannot yet exist (regulations).	ADVANCED still not commenced
Data protection	Data protection authority	A Data Protection Supervisory Authority sits at Part 2 of a draft bill that has not been tabled, and no authority exists. The draft's stated objects are establishing the authority with its own powers and duties, obligations on controllers and processors, rights for data subjects, and codes of conduct (draft , earlier version). A civil-society critique of the 2022 consultation argued the sections on the authority's independence need substantial redrafting. Four years on there is no authority, no commencement and no later text.	STALLED
Data protection	National data protection readiness		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	Memoranda were signed with Angola and Botswana, and cabinet authorised signature with the Republic of Congo. The Angolan memorandum covers joint events, exchange of expertise and cybersecurity, with no amount or instrument named (Angola). The Botswana memorandum was signed at Kasane in August 2026 between the two ministries with their operators and regulators, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills; the two sides costed the corridor's remaining 4G gaps at about N\$52 million across thirteen new sites and recorded a completed cross-border fibre link, the first direct one between the operators (Botswana , cooperation). Cabinet approved a memorandum with the Republic of Congo and authorised the minister to sign, with no scope, financing or signature date published (Congo).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	The regional regulators' legal and policy committee first met at Windhoek in August 2026, and the minister holds a seat on an international artificial-intelligence commission. The committee was constituted and met with artificial-intelligence governance, data governance and protection, digital public infrastructure and regional regulatory harmonisation on its agenda, hosted by the national regulator; no work programme, output or timetable is published (committee). The ICT minister is one of eight Africans on a forty-four member commission, on the convening body's account (seat , declaration).	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	A master service agreement with two Angolan counterparts commits 1.0 Tbps of dedicated capacity, and a satellite pilot is running. The agreement was signed in June 2026 by the state fixed operator with two Angolan counterparts, with the Namibian operator as landing party hosting Angolan equipment, covering design, integration, testing, commissioning and handover; it builds on a memorandum and commercial terms agreed in April 2026 (agreement , deals). Initial dedicated transmission capacity on the subsea system is fixed at 1.0 Tbps by that agreement, as stated by the parties, with no delivered figure held (capacity). A pilot commercial agreement between the state fixed operator and Angola's space agency is running, with full commercial launch targeted after the pilot (pilot).	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National quality standards		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	Adoption of international standards	The regulator states it is the national root certification authority, and the interbank settlement system migrated to the international messaging standard. The regulator states it anchors the digital trust framework and regulates certificate and certification-service providers, a role the ministry had exercised in accrediting electronic-signature providers under the 2019 statute; that places the trust anchor inside the communications regulator rather than a separate cyber agency (accreditation). The interbank settlement system has migrated to the ISO 20022 messaging standard (migration pact).	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	The 2022 consultation on the Data Protection Bill drew a coalition submission and an independent critique, and no further consultation is on record. The ministry opened public input in October 2022 with a closing date of 30 November; a civil-society coalition filed a submission on that date and a research institute published the same argument as a public paper in December, arguing the sections on the supervisory authority's independence need substantial redrafting and that the offences and penalties provisions are undeveloped (consultation submission critique). No ministry-published list of respondents is held and no further consultation activity is on record since. A separate three-year memorandum between the regulator and the chamber of commerce takes legislative reform as a joint workstream with a business lobby, which the instrument does not address (memorandum).	NO CHANGE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy		NO EVIDENCE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	A universal service levy of up to 0.5 per cent of turnover has been in force since 2024, and the Universal Service Fund has awarded nine sites, while the regulator turned a surplus into a loss. The levy is not to exceed 0.5 per cent of annual turnover per licensee with a flat N\$500 floor for non-profit licensees, invoiced on audited statements and payable within thirty days into the fund (regulations); an amendment let the fund receive donations or grants, which is what makes government funding receivable (regulations , withdrawal). A gap analysis identifies 119 locations that will remain unserved after coverage obligations, of which government funding covers the capital cost of 42 (analysis). The fund launched in March 2025 and a first bidding round awarded nine sites with almost N\$31 million of capital subsidy across the five regions where 4G coverage is below 80 per cent, with free internet for schools and clinics on those sites for seven years (fund , priority , report). The government commitment is given as N\$115,000,000 in the regulator's own report and N\$145,000,000 in the launch reporting, and the two are not reconciled (launch). The regulator's revenue fell 23 per cent to 15.5 per cent below budget while operating expenditure rose 42 per cent, turning a N\$32.8 million surplus into a N\$25.5 million loss (accounts , prior year).	MIXED a universal service levy in force and a fund disbursing while the fund's own seed figure is unreconciled and the regulator ran a loss
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships		NO EVIDENCE
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance		NO EVIDENCE
New investments	Development-partner project financing		NO EVIDENCE

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	4G population coverage was 88.4 per cent on 2023 data, commercial 5G is live in three centres, and operators have been instructed to retire 2G and 3G. The regulator's series gives 4G population coverage of 85 per cent in 2022, with six of fourteen regions below 80 per cent and one at 41 per cent, 456 of 1,380 schools and 84 of 452 health facilities without 4G coverage, and about 2,000,000 of 2,900,000 mobile cards actively used for internet (2022); the 2023 edition gives coverage of 88.4 per cent, fibre to the home at 27 per cent of fixed broadband subscribers and a 6 per cent fall in active cards (2023 , release). The published series is irregular and no edition reporting 2024 data is held (series). Commercial 5G launched at the end of August 2025 in three centres, with nationwide deployment stated as phased and city-first (5G). The regulator has instructed operators to retire 2G and 3G and refarm the spectrum; the incumbent asked government to subsidise smartphones before switch-off, and no switch-off date or government response is on file (retirement).	MIXED 5G live in three centres and 2G and 3G ordered retired while the regulator's own published series stops at 2023
Connectivity	Internet usage		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	The regulator's chief executive proposed tax relief on fourth-generation devices, against operator-reported tower utilisation close to half in one region. The proposal was made at a tower launch in Kunene; no fiscal instrument, budget line or ministerial response has been published, and the operator reported utilisation close to 50 per cent across about 74 enabled towers in the region (proposal). Device cost, not coverage, is what the proposal treats as the constraint, and the incumbent made the same argument a year later in asking for smartphone subsidies before the 2G and 3G switch-off.	NO CHANGE a regulator proposal with no fiscal instrument or ministerial response behind it
Connectivity	National fibre backbone		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	A satellite licence application was declined and 622 of 624 reconsideration requests failed, under a 51 per cent Namibian ownership requirement the applicant cannot meet. Licence and spectrum were declined in March 2026 on three of six statutory criteria; 622 of 624 reconsideration requests failed the legal threshold, two were refused on merits, and the operator's own request was dismissed as out of time (dismissal , rejection , block). The ownership requirement is in force with no exemption granted; the regulator held that wholly foreign ownership raises questions of jurisdiction, enforceability of compliance obligations and effective oversight, and states the power to waive the rule rests with the minister rather than with it (requirement). The applicant stated its global shareholding rules bar it from accepting local ownership (exemption).	REGRESSED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	Two commercial data centres are named as established, one operator-run and one run by an aerospace company with a national university. No capacity, load or customer figures are held for either facility (facilities). They are the whole of the country's operating data-centre estate on this record, and the case for hosting compute in the country rests on the subsea landing rather than on installed capacity.	NO CHANGE two commercial facilities named with no capacity, load or customer figure for either
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	A national public data centre is at concept-note stage, while a vendor-built facility for artificial-intelligence workloads is being built on a Chinese commitment. Cabinet directed a concept note and project proposal to the ministry and the Office of the Prime Minister in September 2025, and no site, capacity, cost or date was published by August 2026; the minister said in June 2026 that Angola's national facility had encouraged the plan (concept , proposal , encouragement). A vendor is building smart-city solutions and a data centre with the ICT and home affairs ministries, on a Chinese commitment of CNY 98,000,000 given by the source as about US\$14.4m (funding); no signed agreement, annexure or contractor list is held, and an opposition member gives the same commitment as N\$245m (funding , talks).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Grid reliability		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	Cabinet approved a government-sector incident response team and security operations centres and a cyber-skills programme for government technology staff, neither established. The team was approved as the central authority coordinating incidents across government, with the Office of the Prime Minister directed to coordinate phased implementation; no establishment, budget or timetable is reported (team). Targeted training in cyber hygiene, incident response and threat intelligence was approved alongside it, with no delivery, budget or cohort reported nine months later (training).	ADVANCED approved not established
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems		NO EVIDENCE
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	The national incident response team completed its three-year plan and publishes an annual landscape report, while detected vulnerabilities rose 39.8 per cent in a quarter. The team operates under the regulator, was officially launched in April 2025, completed Phase 3 of its implementation plan in the 2025/26 year, and joined three international and regional bodies during 2025; about US\$1m is allocated to cybersecurity for 2026/27 (team , surge , growth). The 2025 landscape report records 1,701,883 attack events, up about 37 per cent on 2024, and 2,231,970 vulnerabilities, with five ransomware victims (report); the country scored 36.93 on an international cybersecurity index in 2024 against 11.47 in 2020, and the team states in its own text that it cannot fully execute its mandate absent a cybersecurity law (report , inaugural). Incident management guidelines came into force in April 2026 setting out detection, reporting and coordinated response (guidelines), and detected vulnerabilities and events rose 39.8 and 56.7 per cent in the following quarter (quarter).	MIXED the response team fully operational and publishing while detected vulnerabilities rose 39.8 per cent in a quarter and no cybersecurity law exists

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	A governmental interoperability solution delivered in 2016, a data exchange service bus reported operating in 2020 and an inter-ministry platform being deployed in 2025 are all the base holds. The interoperability solution was delivered by an external academy with a technology partner on a project running to December 2016, and no operational status has been published since (solution). The service bus was reported in a 2020 case study as linking electronic birth and death notification platforms to the population register, and no operational statement has been published since (bus). An inter-ministry data-exchange platform was named as being deployed in September 2025 with no record since (platform). Whether the three are the same system is not established, which is itself the state of the record.	NO CHANGE three interoperability systems on file and no operational statement for any of them since 2020
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	A chipped electronic identity card with a ten-year validity is confirmed for September 2026, carrying a randomly generated number for first-time applicants. The card holds biometric and biographical data plus a digital identity component for remote authentication, with a thumbprint, a facial image and a personal identification number issued as on a bank card, and is valid for ten years against the indefinite lifespan of the document it replaces; a July 2026 launch was announced and slipped, cabinet approved the card in 2023, and none had been issued by August 2026 (card , announcement , validity). Identity numbers had been derived from date of birth; first-time applicants will get a random number, with legacy numbers retained on the reverse of the card and existing documents valid until withdrawn by gazette notice (number , account).	ADVANCED slipped

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	117,175 identity documents were issued in 2025, and 40,238 of 166,237 printed were left uncollected over fifteen months. The minister gave 117,175 national identity documents, 126,737 birth certificates and 682 refugee cards issued in 2025 (issuance); the 2024 comparator held in the base is a campaign count rather than an annual series (issuance , budget). Between April 2025 and June 2026, 166,237 documents were printed, 125,999 collected and 40,238 left uncollected, about a quarter of the print run (uncollected). A school-based drive reached 24 of 55 target schools by July 2026, with officials returning to each school to hand printed documents to learners rather than requiring a ministry visit; documentary requirements are unchanged, which the source names as the residual barrier for learners with incomplete birth registration (drive).	MIXED a school-based registration drive running while about a quarter of printed documents go uncollected
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	The electronic identity is free at the point of issue for first-time applicants, renewals, amendments and error replacements, with a first duplicate at N\$150. A first duplicate costs N\$150 and a second N\$300 (fees); the schedule was stated by ministry officials at Gobabis and on a regional awareness tour (fees , expiry). Free issue with a charge only for duplicates is the arrangement most likely to move the uncollected-document figure, and no fee for the card's digital component is separately stated.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The Payment System Management Act 14 of 2023 is in force, licensing is moving to the central bank, and a vision to 2030 succeeds a strategy that closed at 87 per cent implementation. The Act commenced in August 2023 and the payments association moved from a management council to a management board under it during 2025 (Act , board). Licensing and supervision of payment providers are to move to the central bank, with the association given independent governance and its own funding model; no instrument, commencement date or transition plan is published (transfer). The 2021-2025 strategy closed at an 87 per cent average implementation rate over five years (strategy), succeeded by a vision to 2030 whose next phase is in drafting on interoperable instant payments, the quick-response standard, open banking and cyber resilience (vision).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	Government-to-person social grants are the first use case named for the instant payment system, which went live in June 2026. Biometric arrangements for the payment system were being weighed a year before it went live (biometrics). No grant volume, beneficiary count or disbursement figure through the system is published (launch), so the base records the channel that has been chosen for social transfers and not what has passed through it.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	Open banking specifications are complete, with implementation named a priority under the payments vision and no date published. The specifications were reported completed in July 2026 through the payments association's annual report, which is not itself held (specifications). No participating institution, interface standard or pilot is named. Completed specifications with no implementation date are the same shape as the quick-response standard beside them.	NO CHANGE specifications complete with no implementation date published

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	An Instant Payment Solution went live in June 2026 with three participating institutions; a declaration of intent was signed on clearing integration, and a quick-response standard is finalised. The solution became operational in June 2026 after a live pilot, with a phased national rollout; the go-live month is stated by the central bank and no day is given (launch , build). A declaration of intent was signed by the central bank, the instant payments company and the clearing house to integrate instant payments with the national clearing infrastructure through the interbank settlement system, with no deliverables, funding or timetable published (declaration). The national quick-response payment standard is finalised with operationalisation named a priority and no live deployment reported (standard).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Financial inclusion is put at 86 per cent for 2025, with an earlier 78 per cent figure dated to 2017 in one account and described as current in another. The deputy governor gave 86 per cent at the payments association's annual general meeting, with the 78 per cent figure dated to 2017 (rate). An industry executive had described the same 78 per cent as current in July 2025 (executive). The two accounts date the same figure eight years apart, which is why the direction here is recorded and the size of the gain is not.	ADVANCED dating unreconciled
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	Card e-commerce acceptance opened to merchants in August 2026, while participation in the continental payment and settlement system is still not on record. Online acceptance of an international card scheme opened to participating merchants, settling in local currency, dollars or both, as part of an extension to nine African markets; no country-specific merchant count is given (acceptance , extension). A regional bank targeted central bank sign-up to the continental system by a Windhoek seminar in November 2024, and no record of Namibian participation exists at August 2026; about thirteen African central banks and 115 commercial banks were then on the platform (system).	MIXED card e-commerce acceptance opened while participation in the continental settlement system remains unrecorded

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	Banking fraud losses reached N\$73.9m in 2025 against about N\$8.7m a year in 2020, and a fraud and cybersecurity summit convened once. Losses ran at about N\$8.7m a year in 2020 on the central bank's figure and reached N\$73.9m for 2025, with N\$65m lost between January and October (losses); no 2026 figure is held (losses). An inaugural summit was convened by the ICT ministry with the central bank, the bankers' association, the incident response team and an industry cyber council, and no second edition has been reported (summit).	REGRESSED
Registries	Population register	The national population registration system has been operating since at least 2020 and is the register the September 2026 card is built on. A 2021 baseline found obsolete software, siloed databases and little interoperability; the system now operates with remote biometric enrolment tested through hand-held devices (system , case study). No enrolment count, coverage share or performance figure is published for it, so the register underneath the country's identity programme is described and not measured.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Civil register	The civil registration department had N\$178,122,000 for 2025/26 and no 2026/27 allocation is on file. A separate N\$70m was allocated to the digital identity within a N\$7.4bn ministry budget (allocation). No 2026/27 civil-registration allocation is on file (budget), which matters in the year the electronic card is to be issued and the school-based registration drive is running.	NO CHANGE no 2026/27 allocation published against the previous year's N\$178.1m
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Business register	A Corporate Laws Bill at third draft would require every company to keep a beneficial-owner register in Namibia, above existing online registration services. The draft consolidates and re-enacts the Companies Act with the business and intellectual property authority as registrar, and its clause 114 would require every company, and every external company establishing a place of business in the country, to keep a register of beneficial owners recording each owner's name, date of birth, identity-document number and residential, business, email and postal addresses; company process is routed through the electronic transactions statute (bill). Online name search, name reservation and application-status verification are already offered, with no transaction or uptake figure published (services).	ADVANCED
Registries	Social protection register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Electoral register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Land register		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Health	A National Digital Health Policy 2026-2036 was launched in February 2026, succeeding a strategy whose period expired, and a community health application is in preparation. The ten-year policy was developed by the health ministry with international technical support, naming interoperability across health information systems, service delivery, governance and evidence-based decision-making as the problem it addresses; no funding, implementation plan or target is published, and it is known through a regional office's account rather than the ministry's own (policy). The 2021-2025 strategy's period expired at the end of 2025 and the successor followed five weeks later (strategy , succession). A mobile application for community health workers is in preparation with phased deployment and paper and digital running in parallel, after national training in July 2026; no rollout date is announced (application).	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Education		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Tax		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Customs		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	The digital government roadmap targets digital identities for at least a quarter of the population by 2026, electronic signatures missed a February 2026 launch, and full digitisation is targeted for 2029/30. The roadmap runs 2024-2026 and no digital-identity coverage figure has been published, with card issuance beginning only in September 2026; the document is known through one outlet's account (roadmap). Accreditation of electronic-signature service providers was under way with nationwide deployment targeted for February 2026; that target passed without a launch on record, and the capability is now described as a component of the September 2026 identity card (signatures , accreditation). Full digitisation of government services is targeted for 2029/30 with no delivery measure published (target), and a N\$13 million roads project control system was commissioned in August 2026 with no public access to its dashboard stated (roads).	MIXED a roadmap target of digital identities for a quarter of the population by 2026 against card issuance beginning only in September and electronic signatures that missed their launch

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	The capital adopted a People-Centred Smart City Strategy 2026-2036 in June 2026, with no funding requirement, timetable or institutional owner published. The strategy was adopted by the city council in June 2026 and handed over in partnership with two United Nations bodies; the named projects are commercialisation of the city's own fibre network as the digital backbone and a proposed commuter rail (strategy , reactions). A Chinese contribution to the pilot was acknowledged in July 2026 (contribution), reported as CNY 98m and as N\$245m with no dated conversion between them (concerns); smart-city development had been under discussion since 2025 with no instrument published (discussion).	ADVANCED
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	21 of 188 schools in one region have workable connectivity, leaving 55,002 learners without digital teaching tools, against a national figure of 339 schools and 50 health centres lacking adequate connectivity. The regional education directors told the parliamentary ICT committee that 21 of Kavango West's 188 schools have workable connectivity, leaving 55,002 learners without digital teaching tools, and that the neighbouring region's 197 schools serving 86,282 learners are only marginally connected (committee); health officials told the same committee that clinics still struggle with unreliable coverage (committee , schools , clinics). The ministry's national figure of 339 schools and 50 health centres lacking adequate connectivity dates from June 2025 with no later official figure; a research council account records 65.4 per cent of schools connected in 2023, 1,311 of 2,004, on a different basis that is not comparable (national , council).	REGRESSED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	Cabinet ordered a N\$39.5m artificial-intelligence crop-monitoring contract cancelled in August 2026, weeks after the one-year contract was reported. The contract, in effect from June 2026, was to build a national crop-monitoring system using satellite imagery, geospatial analysis and artificial intelligence to map agricultural land, monitor crop and pasture health and forecast five crops, with software, models and technical expertise transferred to the ministry and officials trained to run it independently (contract). Cabinet ordered it cancelled in the week of 17 August 2026 and the agriculture ministry is weighing action against the official who authorised it; government did not attribute the cancellation to the technology, the value is reported as N\$39.5m and N\$40m in different accounts, and the review itself is not published (cancellation , block , account). The award had drawn public objection over transparency and local participation, and no procurement route or text of the data-ownership terms was published.	REGRESSED
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	Namibia is one of five backing governments in a pan-African language artificial-intelligence initiative, and an indigenous-language voice repository is under construction. The initiative was launched at a continental telecommunications conference with the ICT ministry a named partner, scaling an existing national model template; the stated commitment is ministerial support rather than a named contribution, and no Namibian funding, dataset or deliverable is published (initiative , declaration , account). A voice-data repository for Namibian indigenous languages is being built through a development programme sprint with the national science and technology university; no language count, corpus size, licence or release date is stated, and who owns the collected speech and on what terms it can train models is not addressed (repository).	ADVANCED
AI	Control of AI abuse		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	The first privately owned mobile network launched in September 2025 on N\$600m of investment, against a dominance determination naming the state operator dominant in all four priority markets. The network is live on long-term evolution and 5G, with N\$600m invested in the preceding year and N\$1.42bn in Namibian network infrastructure since 2018, company-reported (launch , announcement , investment , record). The 2024 determination names the state fixed operator dominant in all four priority markets, alone in wired end-user access and jointly elsewhere, with termination treated as a natural monopoly; the regulator describes its approach across all three exercises as one of minimal intervention (determination).	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	A national artificial-intelligence institute recommended by a 2022 task force is proposed and not established, with no site, budget, host or founding instrument on file. The sixth national development plan calls for a research centre and the institute remains proposed (institute). Four years after the recommendation there is no site, budget, host or founding instrument. The working capability the country has instead sits in a university accelerator recorded separately.	NO CHANGE
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	Cabinet authorised an information technology venture capital fund at US\$20m and directed engagement with female founders as potential beneficiaries. No fund manager, first close, instrument, Namibian-dollar figure or disbursement is on file eleven months later (fund). The amount is published only in United States dollars, so the row cannot carry the announcing party's own currency, and no count of firms, deals or jobs is held for the country.	NO CHANGE a fund authorised at US\$20m with no manager, close or disbursement on file

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	A public-service cyber training partnership was signed in June 2026 for joint training of public servants, extending to private-sector professionals. No funding, cohort size or delivery date is published, and the memorandum text is not held (partnership). It sits beside a cabinet-approved cyber-skills programme for government technology staff that has also not reported a cohort, so the civil service has two approved training routes and no trained count.	ADVANCED
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	No standalone national digital-literacy strategy or programme exists outside the school curriculum. The Information and Communication subject is the country's whole digital-literacy provision on this record, compulsory and assessable for school pupils and reaching nobody else (curriculum). No adult programme, measurement or target is held. The identity awareness campaign and the youth ambassador programme recorded elsewhere in this ledger are the nearest thing to population-level digital outreach, and both are about one credential.	NO CHANGE
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	An Information and Communication syllabus is compulsory and assessable across Grades 4 to 12, and a learning platform launched in August 2026. The subject runs across three themes of digital, media and information literacy; the Grade 12 syllabus was published in 2018 for implementation in 2021 and the Grade 8 and 9 syllabus in December 2024 for phased implementation in 2025 and 2026 (syllabus , senior secondary). A digital and offline learning platform aimed at rural, remote and underserved young people was launched by the education ministry with an international agency; no user target, content catalogue, device requirement or offline distribution route is stated (platform).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	A university artificial-intelligence and robotics accelerator underpins the country's first artificial-intelligence degree, and a five-node computing cluster is specified for a university campus. The accelerator was launched with central bank funding and supports bachelor's and honours degrees in artificial intelligence and a master's in data science; it is known through the research council's authors citing the university's own announcement (accelerator). A five-node high-performance computing cluster is specified for deployment at the science and technology university under a bilateral centre of excellence, with no operator, cost or opening date published; it is a university research cluster and the source itself warns it must not be conflated with a national facility (cluster).	ADVANCED
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy		NO EVIDENCE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	An electronic identity awareness campaign is running region by region in local languages, with a youth ambassadors programme promoting take-up. The campaign opened in the capital region and its Omaheke leg ran across all seven constituencies in late July and early August 2026, run by home affairs with a development agency and the regulator, with a brand ambassador running sessions in local languages (campaign , conference , preparation). A youth ambassadors programme uses young people to promote take-up and civic participation; participant numbers, cost, duration and any enrolment effect are not stated, and the funding agency's own account is the only source (ambassadors).	ADVANCED
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	682 refugee identity cards were issued in 2025, and cash assistance through mobile money reached about 6,000 people in 2025. Issuance of refugee cards began in June 2024 and 682 were issued in calendar 2025 (cards , system). Cash assistance through mobile money launched in February 2025 for about 6,000 individuals in over 1,000 households, with the agency reporting it held 40 per cent of the resources needed and no record since (assistance).	ADVANCED
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	Twenty-five towers entered service across nine regions, schools and clinics under new towers get seven years free internet, and 100 per cent coverage is targeted for 2030. Twenty-five towers went into service across nine regions at N\$40m in total, about N\$1.6m each, built with the state fixed operator (towers). Schools and clinics under towers built in the previous two years get free internet for seven years, on N\$80m in nine radio access network towers over two years (free internet); no list or count of covered schools or clinics is published (free internet). The 2030 coverage target was set in June 2025 against about 360,000 people, roughly 12 per cent, outside 4G coverage at February 2024, with a parallel internet-use target of 53 to 90 per cent by 2030 (target , plan). Siting delays on communal land are the constraint the ministry names, and it met the traditional authorities' trust with the regulator and three operators in July 2026 with no agreement reported (siting).	ADVANCED

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	A national strategy for the development of statistics runs 2023/24 to 2026/27 at N\$58,995,000, alongside the agency's own institutional strategic plan. The strategy sets four goals covering better use of statistics for policy, efficient data processes, a better funded national statistics system and improved integration with spatial data, resting on ten first-phase sector plans, at a total implementation cost of N\$58,995,000 over four years (strategy). The agency's separate institutional plan covers 2022/23 to 2026/27 on four focus areas including spatial data coordination and alternative data sources, and records that funding was relatively adequate until about 2016 and that the population census slipped twice for want of funds (plan). The two are distinct documents and should not be merged.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The 2023 population and housing census was the country's first fully digital census and remains the reference count at 3,022,401. It is cited by the statistics agency as a step in modernising the national statistical system (census , awareness). The agency's own institutional plan records that the census slipped from August 2021 and again from August 2022 for want of funds, so the digital operation was delivered two years late and no successor is scheduled on this record.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	The producer price index moved off spreadsheets onto an automated engine with revisions back to 2015, and the quarterly bulletin is now held as a primary. Compilation moved to an automated processing engine, disclosed in the second-quarter 2026 bulletin and carrying retrospective revisions of producer price estimates back to 2015: missing prices are now imputed as a turnover-weighted average of observed price relatives within the product group, imputation is capped at three consecutive periods before an item must be replaced, and automated validation flags extreme swings and entry errors (system). The bulletin itself is held in full where the base had carried its figures only as reported, and it carries no digital-sector breakout (bulletin). The country has subscribed to an international data dissemination standard since December 2022, one of about seven African countries (subscription), and held an inaugural statistics awareness day in July 2026 themed on statistics in the digital age (day).	ADVANCED
Open data	Use of open data	The statistics agency runs data portals and a microdata catalogue of sixteen studies with stated access terms, while a reporting application and an environmental platform publish no dataset. The agency operates a data portals page and a catalogue holding sixteen Namibian studies from 1992 to 2023, each carrying a stated access term; the source states explicitly that this is agency-run dissemination and not a government-wide open data policy or portal, which the base does not hold for the country (catalogue). An infrastructure reporting application launched nationwide takes public reports of more than thirty kinds of fault onto a mapped national dataset with automatic facial and licence-plate redaction; it is privately built and privately held, with no user count, data-sharing arrangement with any authority, or licence for the dataset stated (application). An environmental agreements monitoring platform launched at N\$12m to centralise environmental data for planning and national reporting, with no public access, dataset list, licence or publication rule stated, so it is a reporting tool rather than open data on the record held (platform).	MIXED an agency microdata catalogue with stated access terms against two new platforms that publish nothing

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	A satellite data-receiving ground station is in operation, the country's first, and a Space Science and Technology Bill has been approved for drafting with no text published. The station was handed over by China at the earth station outside Windhoek and receives remote-sensing data, operated by fourteen trained Namibians (station , handover). Cabinet approved drafting of a space statute during 2025 and no text or introduction date has been published (bill , approval). The country's one recorded application of satellite data to agriculture, a crop-monitoring contract, was cancelled by cabinet in August 2026.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	A subsea cable landing at Swakopmund has been in service since 2022 and is the only United States technology asset in the country the base carries outside satellite licensing. The landing is cited as the connectivity leg of the case for hosting compute in the country (landing , ownership). No hyperscaler memorandum, region, data centre or commitment is recorded, and the one American satellite operator to apply for a licence was refused. So the relationship is a cable and a refusal.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	China committed CNY 98,000,000 to the capital smart-city pilot, is building a data centre for artificial-intelligence workloads and handed over the country's first satellite ground station. The commitment, about US\$14.4m on the source's conversion, covers digital infrastructure, artificial-intelligence capability and skills under the city's ten-year strategy (commitment); the signature date is padded from a reference to the end of June, and an opposition member gives the same commitment as N\$245m (commitment , talks , record). A vendor is building smart-city solutions and a data centre with two ministries, with no signed agreement, annexure or contractor list held (data centre). The satellite ground station outside the capital was handed over by China and is operated by fourteen trained Namibians (station). An opposition member has raised data-control concerns about the smart-city grant.	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	The European indicative programme has no digital priority area, allocating EUR 26,000,000 for 2025-2027 with digitalisation only cross-cutting. The initial 2021-2024 envelope was an indicative EUR 37,000,000, and the mid-term review set the 2025-2027 allocation at EUR 26,000,000: inclusive green growth twenty, good governance and gender equality two, support measures four, and foundational skills education nil (amendment , programme). The named digital offer is support to Parliament's electronic-parliament blueprint, and data protection and cyber security appear once in the programme, qualified as possible.	NO CHANGE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	A bilateral economic commission with technology transfer and skills in its remit was proposed at a business forum in February 2026, with no agreement signed. The commission's proposed remit covers technology transfer, skills development, industrialisation and manufacturing, and the Gulf side raised investment protection and double-taxation agreements; no Gulf-state digital, data-centre or artificial-intelligence agreement is published (proposal). The forum's own trade list runs to diamonds, scrap metal, charcoal, frozen fish and dates, with the ask being value addition before export, which is the context the technology element sits inside.	ADVANCED proposal only

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	A cyber security memorandum was signed in July 2025 and cooperation was advanced at a joint trade committee in August 2026. The memorandum was signed at State House during a visit, alongside an entrepreneurship centre agreement, and no implementation activity, funding or programme has been reported since (memorandum). Cooperation was advanced at the fourth joint trade committee in New Delhi in August 2026, building on a memorandum signed by the two heads of government in July 2025, with bilateral trade put at more than US\$592m in 2025/26 (committee); the memorandum text is not held and no workstream, funding or timetable is attached (committee). A five-node computing cluster is separately specified for a university campus under a bilateral centre of excellence (cluster).	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Consultancy engagement on the artificial-intelligence framework	A procurement award notice, terms of reference or signed advisory agreement; the base carries two accounts of a 2026-08-03 meeting and the minister's statement that the research council leads, and no contract, scope of work, procurement route or value, with none listed on the central procurement board	2026-08-06
National high-performance computing facility	A research council or ministry announcement, procurement notice or budget line for a national compute facility; the base carries the council's own statement that its data committee is to provide such centres and that securing computing infrastructure is a next step, and separately that a vendor is building a data centre for artificial-intelligence workloads, with no named facility, site, capacity, cost or operator	2026-08-06
Start-up act	A gazetted act or a published bill; a held source records that at 2026-08-09 no gazetted or tabled start-up legislation could be located and that the nearest policy instrument, the National Informal Economy, Start-ups and Entrepreneurship Development Policy, is not published at any URL, so what is outstanding is confirmation that none exists rather than a document	2026-08-06
Government interoperability framework	A published interoperability framework, standard or governing instrument; the base names three data-exchange objects across ten years and establishes no relationship between them, no operating body and no governance rules	2026-08-06
Payments association 2025 annual report	The report itself; the base holds two press accounts of its 2026-07-28 release and no primary, and the association's own site publishes only a memorandum and a board release, so four payment rows stand on press reporting of one unheld document	2026-08-06
National open data policy or government portal	A portal address, a dataset catalogue or a policy document; the subject holds nothing for Namibia, and the nearest held material is central bank and statistics agency statements on administrative data, which concern data quality rather than publication	2026-08-06
Published draft and consultation record of the Data Protection Bill	A ministry consultation notice, submissions register or committee record; the base carries only two sources on this subject and a researcher's statement that the public had not seen the latest draft at 2025-08-17	2026-08-06

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Smart-city grant agreement and annexures	The signed grant agreement, its annexures, the contractor list and the data architecture; the base carries an opposition member's characterisation and a presidential acknowledgement of the amount, with no instrument text, and does not establish the Chinese disbursing agency	2026-08-06
Ratification of the continental convention on cyber security and personal data protection	The continental depositary list entry or a Namibian instrument of ratification or accession; the base carries 20 sources on this subject, all bilateral or convened by an industry body, and none names a continental or regional data-governance instrument Namibia has acceded to	2026-08-06
National digital literacy programme	A named ministry or regulator digital-literacy strategy, curriculum or programme document; the subject carries exactly one Namibian source, the regulator and chamber memorandum of 2026-07-30, which names digital literacy as a workstream with no funding, deliverable or target	2026-08-06
Information and communications technology ministry budget vote	The ministry's vote in the appropriation bill or its budget-vote motivation speech; the base holds no Namibian technology appropriation of any year, and the one appropriation figure held anywhere in the base is the civil registration department's, on a source tagged to other subjects	2026-08-06
Universal Service Fund annual accounts	The fund's annual report, or the regulator's disclosure of levy receipts and project disbursements; the base establishes the fund exists, its launch month, its initial endowment and two in-kind outputs, all from secondary reporting of ministerial statements, and carries no levy rate, contribution base, receipts or project list	2026-08-06
Power supply plan for the national data centre	A power purchase agreement, grid-connection study or energy annex to the data-centre project proposal; the subject carries one Namibian source, a signed opinion piece arguing the case for hosting compute locally, so there is no held statement of how any planned facility would be powered, at what cost, or by whom	2026-08-06

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